

Sudan

Free ways to help, and the context behind them.

Where things stand. The war between the army (SAF) and the Rapid Support Forces (RSF) began on 15 April 2023. The army retook Khartoum in 2025; the RSF took El Fasher in October 2025. Drones now harm civilians on both sides: in August 2026 the RSF struck Khartoum, El Obeid, and other army-held cities, and on 3 September UN investigators said foreign recruitment and weapons transfers are fuelling the war and found reasonable grounds to believe army drones have harmed civilians too. The UN estimated 13.6 million people uprooted in January 2026.

Checked 21 September 2026. Every link goes to its own source.

Displaced 13,600,000

LISTEN

Start with the music.

Streams and album sales pay artists directly. These are starting points, not a canon.

Alsarah & the Nubatones (<https://music.apple.com/us/playlist/colors-sudan-curated-by-alsarah/pl.01b946df2fdc4179a4ae53e8a3dd6fcc>)

Sudanese-American singer and ethnomusicologist Alsarah. Her COLORS SUDAN playlist spans classic and modern Sudan.

Sinkane (<https://www.npr.org/transcripts/1252350810>)

Ahmed Gallab, born in London to Sudanese parents. NPR talks with him about his album We Belong.

Mohammed Wardi (<https://www.last.fm/music/Mohammed+Wardi>)

The “golden throat” (1932–2012). Sang in Arabic and Nubian; spent 13 years in exile.

Two Niles to Sing a Melody (<https://ostinatorecords.bandcamp.com/album/two-niles-to-sing-a-melody-the-violins-synths-of-sudan>)

Ostinato Records’ compilation of Sudanese cassette-era classics. Buy it on Bandcamp.

The new school of Sudanese music (<https://www.okayafrica.com/sudanese-music-new-school-artists/>)

Alsarah, Oddisee, Sinkane, and Mo Kheir on home and identity.

LOOK**Look at the art.**

Painters who carry the place with them, most now working in exile.

Ibrahim El-Salahi (<https://www.vigogallery.com/exhibitions/158-ibrahim-el-salahi-the-khartoum-school.-the-making-of-sharjah-art-foundation-sharjah/>)

Born 1930 in Omdurman; a pioneer of the Khartoum School. Tate Modern gave him a retrospective in 2013.

Salah Elmur (<https://marianeibrahim.com/art-fairs/44/>)

Born in Khartoum in 1966, lives in Cairo. Paintings of daily life along the Blue Nile.

Rashid Diab (<https://www.elsaltodiario.com/sudan/rashid-diab-pintor-enarbola-colores-del-arte-sudanes-frente-al-ruido-guerra>)

Painter and art theorist; author of Visual Art in Sudan (2025).

Disturbance in the Nile (<https://en.casaarabe.es/eventos-arabes/show/disturbance-in-the-nile-sudan%E2%80%99s-artistic-revolution>)

Works by eleven Sudanese artists, taken out of Sudan days before the war and shown in Madrid.

Assil Diab (<https://www.africanews.com/amp/2019/07/24/sudanese-artists-use-graffiti-to-further-the-revolution/>)

Painted portraits of protesters killed in 2019 on the walls of their families' homes.

READ

Good news, and reporting you can check.

Stories of people building something, then outlets that show their sources.

GOOD NEWS

Sudan's Emergency Response Rooms (<https://www.npr.org/sections/goats-and-soda/2025/10/11/g-s1-92906/nobel-peace-prize-nominee-sudan-emergency-response-rooms>)

Volunteer-run kitchens and clinics. A Nobel Peace Prize front-runner two years running, and 2025 winners of the Rafto Prize and the Right Livelihood Award (NPR).

Community kitchens piecing Sudan back together

(<https://proof.csmonitor.com/World/Africa/2024/1023/sudan-civil-war-darfur-famine-emergency-response-room>)

The Christian Science Monitor on how neighbors feed neighbors, a tradition called nafeer.

Golo repairs its own road (<https://www.aljazeera.com/where/sudan/>)

Residents of Golo, Central Darfur, cleared and repaired a rugged road by hand so emergency vehicles can pass (Al Jazeera, August 2026).

REPORTING

Dabanga (<https://www.dabangasudan.org/>)

Independent reporting on Sudan.

Sudan Tribune (<https://sudantribune.com/>)

News and views on Sudan.

UN News: Sudan (<https://news.un.org/en/story/2026/09/1168270>)

Latest UN reporting, including the September 2026 fact-finding report.

Security Council Report (<https://www.securitycouncilreport.org/monthly-forecast/2026-09/sudan-41.php>)

What the Council will decide on Sudan, month by month.

CFR Global Conflict Tracker (<https://www.cfr.org/global-conflict-tracker/conflict/power-struggle-sudan>)

Timeline and running updates.

FOLLOW

People and pages, close to the ground.

Follow widely and check claims against a second source. Local groups organize mostly on Facebook and WhatsApp; the sites below lead to their pages.

PEOPLE AND PAGES

Mutual Aid Sudan Coalition (<https://www.mutualaidsudan.org/>)

Updates and reports from the coalition that funds the rooms.

Dabanga and Sudan Tribune (<https://www.dabangasudan.org/>)

Daily news. See the Read section for both.

LOCAL GROUPS

Emergency Response Rooms (LCC Sudan) (<https://lccsudan.org/>)

The volunteer network behind Sudan's communal kitchens. On Facebook, search "LCC Sudan - غرف طوارئ السودان".

Khartoum State ERR (<https://khartoumerr.org/>)

Updates from the Khartoum State rooms.

GIVE

Give where it lands.

We list organizations, not individual crowdfunding pages, which are the hardest to check. Rising Tigers doesn't handle your money.

Mutual Aid Sudan Coalition (<https://www.mutualaidsudan.org/donate>)

Funds go to Emergency Response Rooms; \$0.95 of every \$1 reaches local responders, per the coalition. Managed by Proximity2Humanity, a registered 501(c)(3).

Donate (<https://www.mutualaidsudan.org/donate>)

UN Sudan Humanitarian Fund (<https://crisisrelief.un.org/en/donate-sudan-crisis>)

A pooled fund that partners with dozens of local NGOs.

Donate (<https://crisisrelief.un.org/en/donate-sudan-crisis>)

CDP Sudan Humanitarian Crisis Fund (<https://disasterphilanthropy.org/funds/cdp-sudan-humanitarian-crisis-fund/>)

The Center for Disaster Philanthropy's fund, focused on grants to mutual aid groups.

Donate (<https://disasterphilanthropy.org/funds/cdp-sudan-humanitarian-crisis-fund/>)

Sudanese American Physicians Association (<https://sapa-usa.org/sudan-war-crisis-emergency-relief/>)

Sudanese-American doctors delivering medical aid in Sudan since 2019.

Donate (<https://sapa-usa.org/sudan-war-crisis-emergency-relief/>)

GlobalGiving Sudan Emergency Fund (<https://www.globalgiving.org/projects/sudan-emergency-fund/>)

Relief fund from a four-star Charity Navigator charity.

Donate (<https://www.globalgiving.org/projects/sudan-emergency-fund/>)

Doctors Without Borders (MSF) (<https://www.doctorswithoutborders.org/>)

Medical care across Sudan.

International Rescue Committee (<https://www.rescue.org/>)

Four-star on Charity Navigator and top-rated by CharityWatch, per the IRC.

UNHCR and Norwegian Refugee Council (<https://www.unhcr.org/donate-unhcr.html>)

Protection and shelter for displaced people. See also the NRC (<https://www.nrc.no/>).

Canadian Foodgrains Bank (<https://foodgrainsbank.ca/donate/sudan/>)

For Canadian donors: food assistance for Sudan.

Watchdog lists: [Charity Navigator's Sudan page](#) and [CharityWatch](#). Check any charity before you give: [Charity Navigator](#), [CharityWatch](#), and [Candid](#). Be wary of anyone who asks for gift cards, crypto, or a wire transfer.

BUY

Buy from the people who make it.

Buying supports makers. To fund relief, use Give.

Eilaf (<https://cairosceen.com/Styled/Eilaf-The-Sudanese-Brand-Weaving-East-African-Art-Into-Bags>)

Sudanese-founded bag label working with artisans in Sudan, Chad, Uganda, and Rwanda.

El Tayeb Nation (<https://m7.org.qa/en/calendar/fta-threads-of-impact/el-tayeb-nation/>)

A Brussels-based couture house by Franco-Sudanese designer Abdelgader El Tayeb, built on Sudanese craft and embroidery.

Nine Sudanese-owned businesses (<https://muslimgirl.com/?p=80957>)

Jewelry, streetwear, skincare, and more, from a MuslimGirl roundup.

UNDERSTAND

A short history, with the disputes marked.

Dates and figures come from the sources linked; where sources disagree, the box says so.

1956

Independence from Britain and Egypt. Civil wars follow (1955–72, 1983–2005); South Sudan becomes independent in 2011.

1989

Omar al-Bashir takes power in a coup.

2003

Fighting in Darfur; government-backed Janjaweed militias, which later become the RSF. In October 2025 the ICC convicted a former Janjaweed leader of war crimes and crimes against humanity (HRW (<https://www.hrw.org/world-report/2026/country-chapters/sudan>)).

2018–2021

A popular uprising ousts Bashir in 2019 and a power-sharing deal follows. A military takeover ends it in October 2021.

April 2023

The army under Abdel Fattah al-Burhan and the RSF under Mohamed Hamdan Dagalo (Hemedti) begin fighting in Khartoum.

2025

The army retakes Khartoum. In January the US State Department determines the RSF committed genocide. By the end of October El Fasher falls to the RSF, with reports of killings of people fleeing (HRW (<https://www.hrw.org/world-report/2026/country-chapters/sudan>)).

2026

UN investigators say the RSF's conduct in El Fasher shows hallmarks of genocide

(<https://www.ohchr.org/en/press-releases/2026/02/sudan-evidence-el-fasher-reveals-genocidal-campaign-targeting-non-arab>) (February). Drones now harm civilians on both sides:

the RSF struck Khartoum, El Obeid, and other cities (<https://english.aawsat.com/arab-world/5306121-rsf-launches-drone-attacks-across-sudan>) in August, and the UN found

reasonable grounds to believe army drones have harmed civilians too

(<https://www.ohchr.org/en/press-releases/2026/09/sudan-external-support-networks-are-fuelling-conflict-and-civilian-harm-un>) (September). The Security Council

(<https://www.securitycouncilreport.org/monthly-forecast/2026-09/sudan-41.php>) weighs

renewing sanctions in September.

What's contested

Both sides are accused of atrocities and of blocking aid. The UN fact-finding mission concluded that the RSF and allied forces used starvation as a method of warfare, a war crime ([HRW](#)).

UN investigators reported on 3 September 2026 that transnational networks recruit and deploy foreign personnel and move weapons to support the RSF, and urged extending the arms embargo to all of Sudan ([UN News](#)). They also found reasonable grounds to believe the army used foreign-supplied drones that harmed civilians ([OHCHR](#)).

Sudan now has rival authorities: an army-aligned government and an RSF-led parallel government.

DO**Two minutes, no money.**

Small, free, specific.

Call, don't post (<https://www.usa.gov/elected-officials>)

Staffers tally calls, not reposts. Say one sentence, then hang up. Find your representatives here.

Back the arms embargo (<https://news.un.org/en/story/2026/09/1168270>)

UN investigators urged extending the arms embargo to all of Sudan. Ask your representatives where they stand.

Read from the Sudanese volunteers directly (<https://www.mutualaidsudan.org/>)

Not a thread: their own site.

Read the sources (https://github.com/TahreemK13/Rising_Tigers_Initiative/blob/main/library/sources.md)

Every figure in our article as a plain-text file, with its source and the date we checked it.